

Support the Willow Springs Bridge

The City of Fort Collins is offering to build a pedestrian and bicycle bridge connecting Willow Springs to the Mail Creek Trail, at no cost to homeowners. Construction is funded through Colorado's lottery-funded conservation programs. If we decline, these funds go to another community.

We don't save money by declining. We give it away.

The bridge is the final link connecting us to the Siphon Overpass (\$4.7M, opened Dec. 2025), the Power Trail, Bacon Elementary, and Tailwinds Park — key infrastructure that connects communities south of Harmony to Fort Collins' network.

+\$18.9K–\$31.5K per home

Trail-Adjacent Homes Sell for 3–5% More

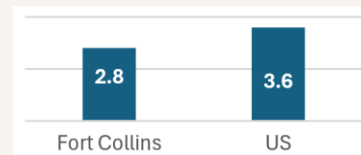
Each \$ represents \$10,000; **bold** represents expected increase

Twenty peer-reviewed studies confirm trail-adjacent homes command a **3–5% premium**. At Willow Springs' ~\$630K median sales price, that's \$18.9K–\$31.5K per home — an **aggregate \$8.7M–\$14.5M** across our 460 properties.

Crime: Fear That Doesn't Materialize

Trails Do Not Invite Crime; Our Trails are Safe

Numerous national studies of hundreds of communities near trails find **no measurable increase in crime**. Our own Bridge committee found zero Poudre Fire Authority emergency calls near the Power Trail in our area from October 2022-2025.



Fort Collins' violent crime rate is 23% below the national average (crimes per 100,000 residents).



9 in 10 Fort Collins residents feel safe on our trails at night.

A Platinum-Rated Bike City...

...Where Our Children Ride Next to Semi Trucks



Fort Collins is one of only three Platinum Bicycle Friendly Communities in the US. Yet Willow Springs children can't safely reach the trail 200 yards from their backyard, which puts us out of step with our community. **The bridge closes this gap.**

Bridge Construction is Free

Trail maintenance is Single-Digit Dollars Per Year

A reasonable planning estimate of **annual maintenance costs** for this trail is **between \$2.15 and \$4.30 per unit per year**.

About 60% of our annual HOA dues go to ongoing maintenance (~ \$314,000), including landscaping, irrigation, and the pond, pool, and playground; *the trail would add less than 0.7% to that.*

Bridge construction is free – Fort Collins covers all costs and maintains the bridge permanently. If we decline, there is no guarantee this offer returns.

This would cost each household less than a gallon of milk per year.



The real cost isn't maintenance: it's the potential permanent loss of a multi-hundred-thousand-dollar investment in our neighborhood if we forgo this opportunity.

The Board votes on the bridge in May. Show up.

We believe every homeowner deserves a vote. If the community doesn't want the bridge, we'll accept that. But the question should be put to a ballot, not decided behind closed doors.

Attend the May board meeting and tell the Board: let the community decide. Thursday May 21st at 6pm.

For more information, including a full analysis with supporting data, visit: [\[WEBSITE URL / QR CODE\]](#)

Questions? WillowSpringsPedestrianBridge@proton.me